

02

WHAT'S IT LIKE TO WALK, BICYCLE AND ROLL IN MOUNTAIN VIEW TODAY?



Community Characteristics

Mountain View is a diverse community with a strong foundation of active transportation infrastructure and transit systems.

Through this ATP, the City aspires to be better. The existing system can be improved to increase connectivity, accessibility and safety, and provide more green infrastructure that can improve public and environmental health within the community by reducing heat exposure, improving air quality, stormwater retention, and biodiversity.

This chapter provides an overview of the existing conditions which is one of the first steps in the development of the MVATP. It describes key aspects of demographics, infrastructure, services, and other community characteristics that influence walking, bicycling, and green streets in Mountain View today. Unless otherwise noted, demographic data are drawn from U.S. Census Bureau American Community Survey (ACS) 2021 5-year estimates.

THE PEOPLE OF MOUNTAIN VIEW

Mountain View is a jobs-rich Santa Clara County community that faces the opportunities and challenges of a strong Silicon Valley economy. The city's population is approximately 82,000, yet it also has a daily influx of workers for more than 100,000 jobs. Two thirds of the population is under the age of 44, and 22% is under 18.

FIGURE 10 STREETScape ALONG CASTRO STREET



DATA SOURCES

for Existing Conditions Analysis:

- City Open Data Portal - spatial data
- Geomate - satellite data
- U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey (ACS) 5-year estimates
- California Statewide Integrated Traffic Records System (SWITRS) - crash data
- Transit Service Data (Santa Clara Valley Transportation Authority (VTA)
- Mountain View Transportation Management Association (MTMA) and Caltrain

The city is ethnically diverse. Approximately 48% of Mountain View residents identify as white, 33% identify as Asian, with Chinese being the predominant Asian ethnicity, and 18% identify as Hispanic or Latino (Table 1). Income in Mountain View spans a wide range. While almost 40% of households earn more than \$200,000 per year and the median household income is \$158,104, approximately 6% of households live below the poverty level.

While the overall population density of Mountain View is low-to-medium, higher densities exist along and between key commercial and transit corridors such as Central Expressway/ Caltrain and El Camino Real, and between Rengstorff Avenue and Escuela and Sierra Vista Avenues (Figure 11). Those neighborhoods also have higher youth densities (Figure 12).

TABLE1 RACE AND ETHNICITY IN MOUNTAIN VIEW

RACE AND ETHNICITY IN MOUNTAIN VIEW	PERCENT OF RESIDENTS
White alone	48.4%
Asian alone	33.3%
Black or African American alone	2.4%
Native American, Native Alaskan alone	0.4%
Native Hawaiian, Pacific Islander alone	0.0%
Some other race alone	5.8%
Two or more races	9.6%
HISPANIC OR LATINO POPULATION	PERCENT OF RESIDENTS
Not Hispanic or Latino	82.0%
Hispanic or Latino	18.0%

Source: ACS 2021 5-year estimate

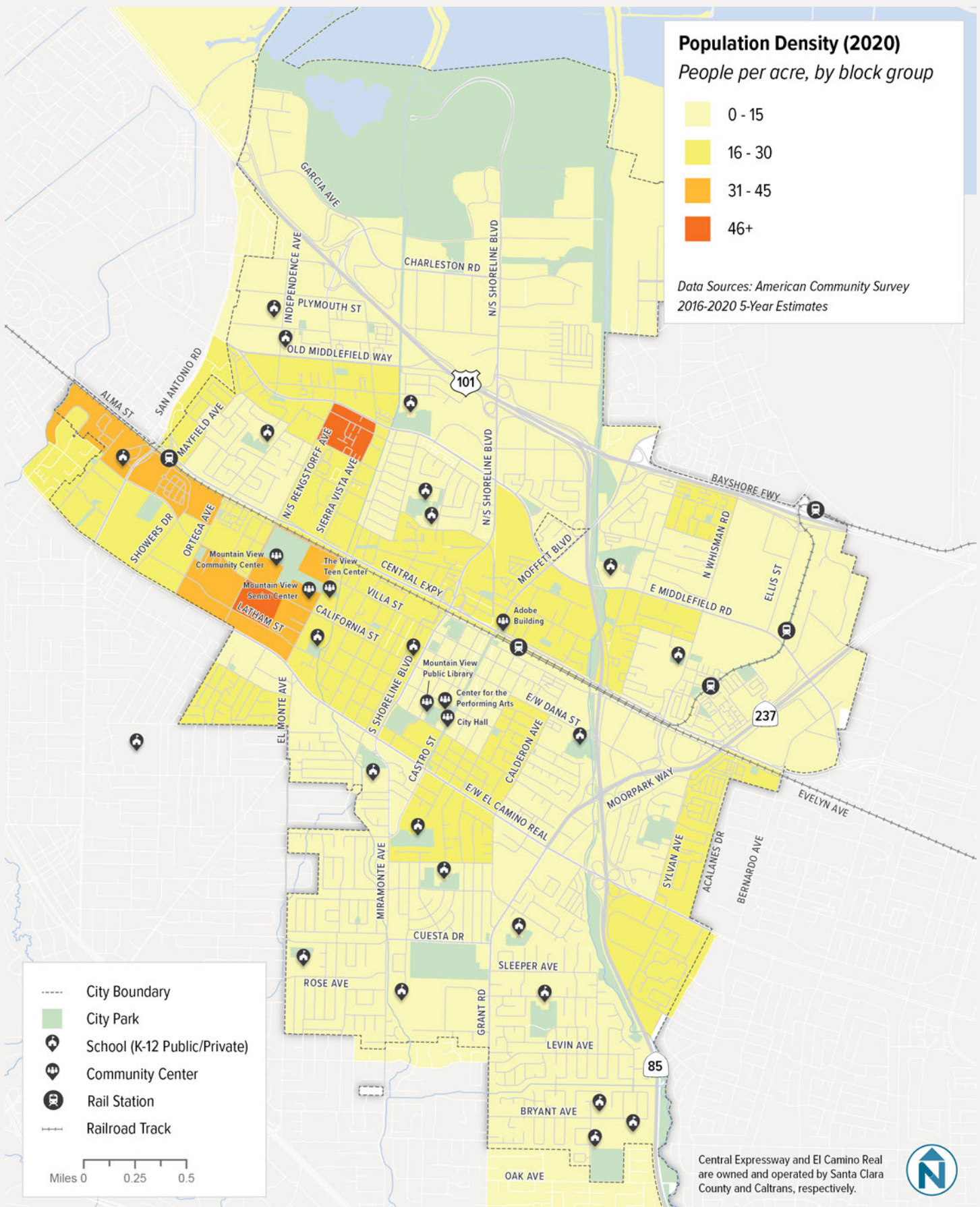
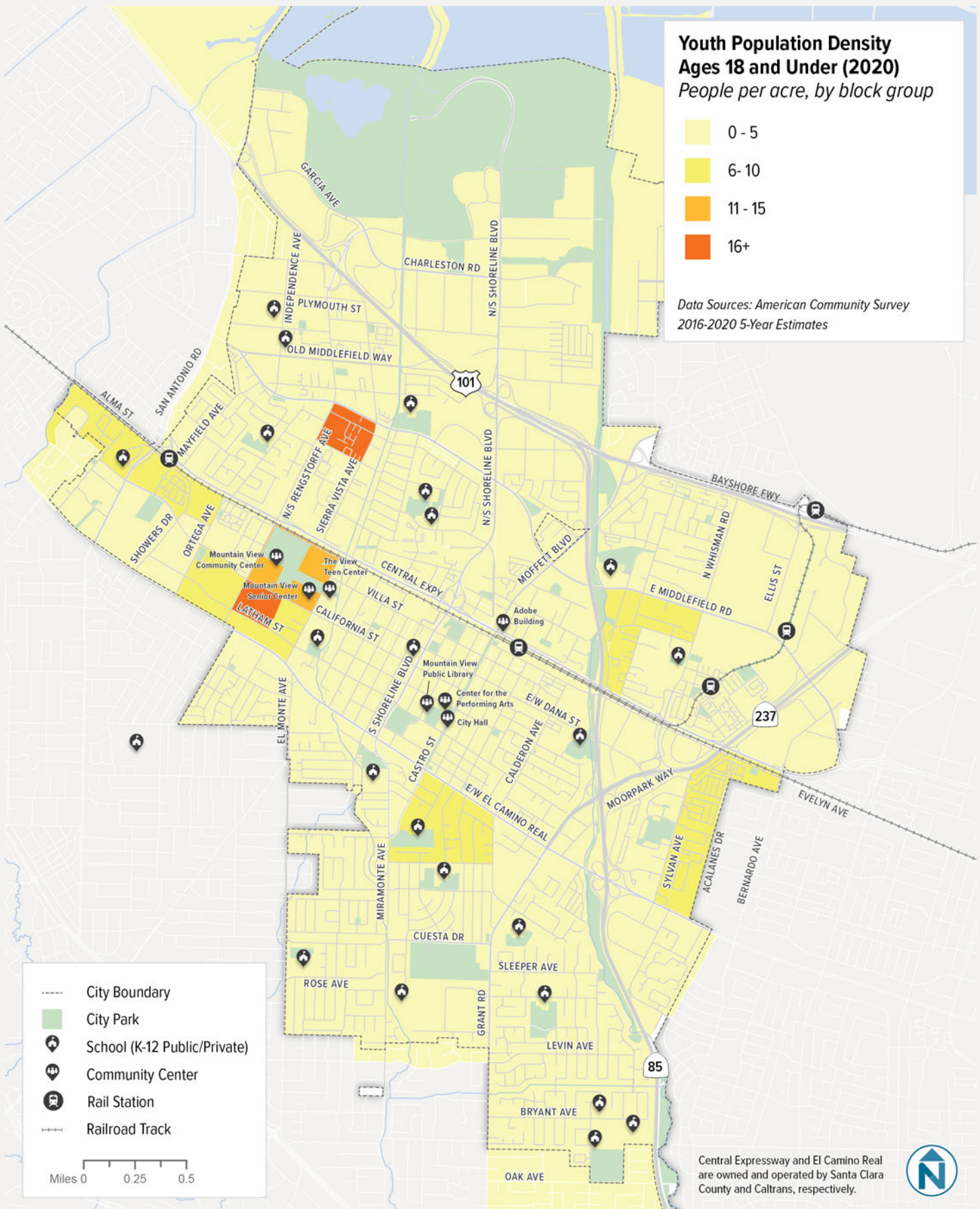


FIGURE 12 YOUTH (AGES 18 AND UNDER) POPULATION DENSITY (2020)



HOW DO WE MOVE ABOUT MOUNTAIN VIEW?

Mountain View is an active community. Census commute data from the ACS 5-year estimate shows that people bicycle to work at far higher rates than other communities in California and the United States. Approximately 3.8% of workers ages 16 and over in Mountain View bicycle to work, compared with 0.7% statewide and 0.4% nationally, while walking rates are comparable to state and national averages at 2.5% (Table 2). Mountain View residents also use public transportation at higher rates than the state and nation, with 3.9% of workers commuting by transit compared with 2.9% statewide and 3.2% nationally.

TABLE 2 COMMUTE MODE COMPARISON

COMMUTE MODE	MOUNTAIN VIEW	CALIFORNIA	UNITED STATES
Drove alone	51.8%	65.7%	68.8%
Carpooled	5.4%	9.5%	8.5%
Public transportation	3.9%	2.9%	3.2%
Walked	2.5%	2.4%	2.4%
Bicycle	3.8%	0.7%	0.4%
Taxicab, motorcycle, or other means	1.9%	1.7%	1.5%
Worked from home	30.6%	17.2%	15.1%

Source: ACS 2024 5-year estimate

Journey to Work data from the U.S. Census only provides a snapshot of walking and bicycling rates by one trip purpose. The Mountain View Safe Routes to School Program conducts an annual Student Travel Tally, capturing how students actually get to and from school. The 2024–2025 findings show that 30% of public-school students in Mountain View get to school by walking, biking, rolling, or transit and 6% carpool. Refer to Table 3 for the breakdown of how students get to school.

TABLE 3 STUDENT TRAVEL MODE SHARE (2024-2025)

PARENTS DROVE/ STUDENTS DROVE ALONE	CARPOOL	PUBLIC TRANSIT	SCHOOL BUS	WALK	BICYCLE	SCOOTER, SKATEBOARD, OR HOVERBOARD
64%	6%	3%	2%	17%	7%	1%

Source: Student Travel Tally Survey (2024-2025), Mountain View Safe Routes to School

Existing Transportation Infrastructure

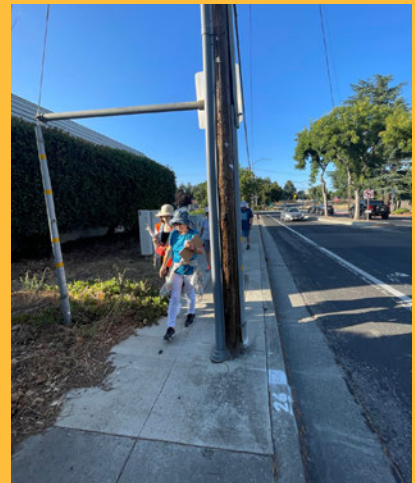
This section summarizes current transportation conditions in Mountain View. It focuses on features that support walking and biking, highlights existing strengths in the active transportation network, and identifies key opportunities for improvement.

PEDESTRIAN INFRASTRUCTURE

Mountain View's sidewalk network is 96% complete and supports walking and rolling throughout the city through a series of connected sidewalks, paseos, plazas, signalized and unsignalized crosswalks, and enhanced crosswalks. Many newer sidewalks provide comfortable pedestrian conditions, allowing two people to walk side by side; however, some older sidewalks and driveways are not up to current standards. While the city's sidewalk network is nearly complete, there are scattered sidewalk gaps and some areas with a higher concentration of missing sidewalks.

Through community engagement, surveys, and field work conducted by Mountain View staff, several existing issues were identified, including uplifted sidewalks, obstructions, deteriorating concrete, and outdated driveway slope design. Community input also indicated that parked cars often block drivers' views of pedestrians on the sidewalk as they pull into driveways. Some of these issues stem from standards that were acceptable at the time of construction but do not reflect current best practices.

FIGURE 13 SIDEWALK CONDITIONS



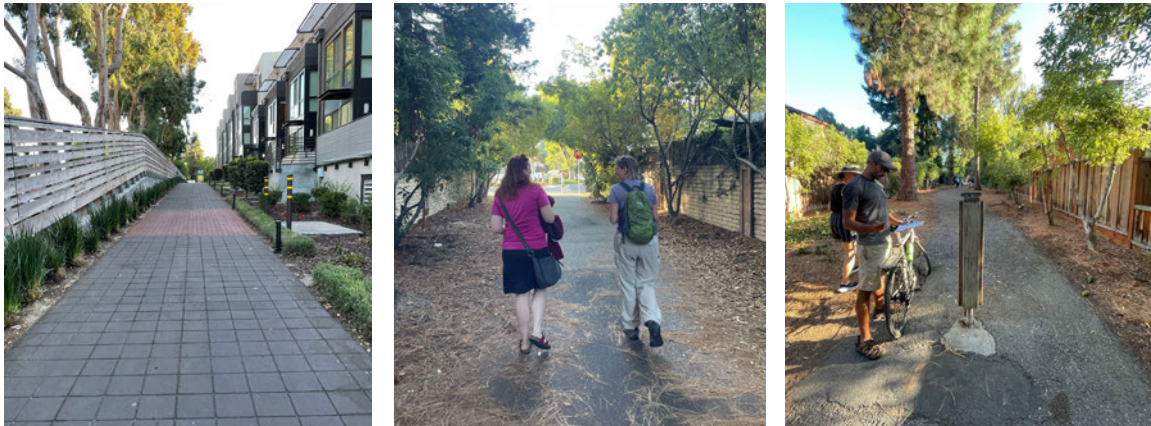
Beyond sidewalks, Mountain View's pedestrian network includes a host of paseos and trails that further support connectivity and mobility throughout the city.

WHAT IS A PASEO?

A paseo is a short connection, often utilizing a public access easement that allows for increased pedestrian and cycling connections. Participants in the Rengstorff Park Walk Tour noted how the paseo connecting Latham to El Camino between Rengstorff and Ortega improved access to destinations on El Camino Real.

Paseos are typically located between buildings, through mid-block connections, and within residential or mixed-use developments. They are often found linking neighborhoods to parks, schools, transit stops, commercial areas, and other community destinations.

FIGURE 14 CAR-FREE PASEO EXAMPLES



Paseos are a valuable tool to provide public permeability for pedestrians and cyclists through private areas. These are often built as part of multi-family residences in Mountain View. They have the added benefit of providing “eyes on the street,” which increases visibility and promotes a sense of community. Survey respondents suggested more publicly accessible pathways, or paseos, through apartment and office complexes near schools and on routes to transit, such as the Caltrain stations, to increase active transportation accessibility.

Mountain View has over 2,100 signalized intersections, marked crosswalks, High-Intensity Activated CrossWalk beacons (HAWKs), LED-enhanced crosswalks, and rectangular rapid flashing beacons (RRFBs), all of which help draw attention to pedestrians crossing the roadway. Crossings are a critical component of walking and bicycling routes throughout the city.

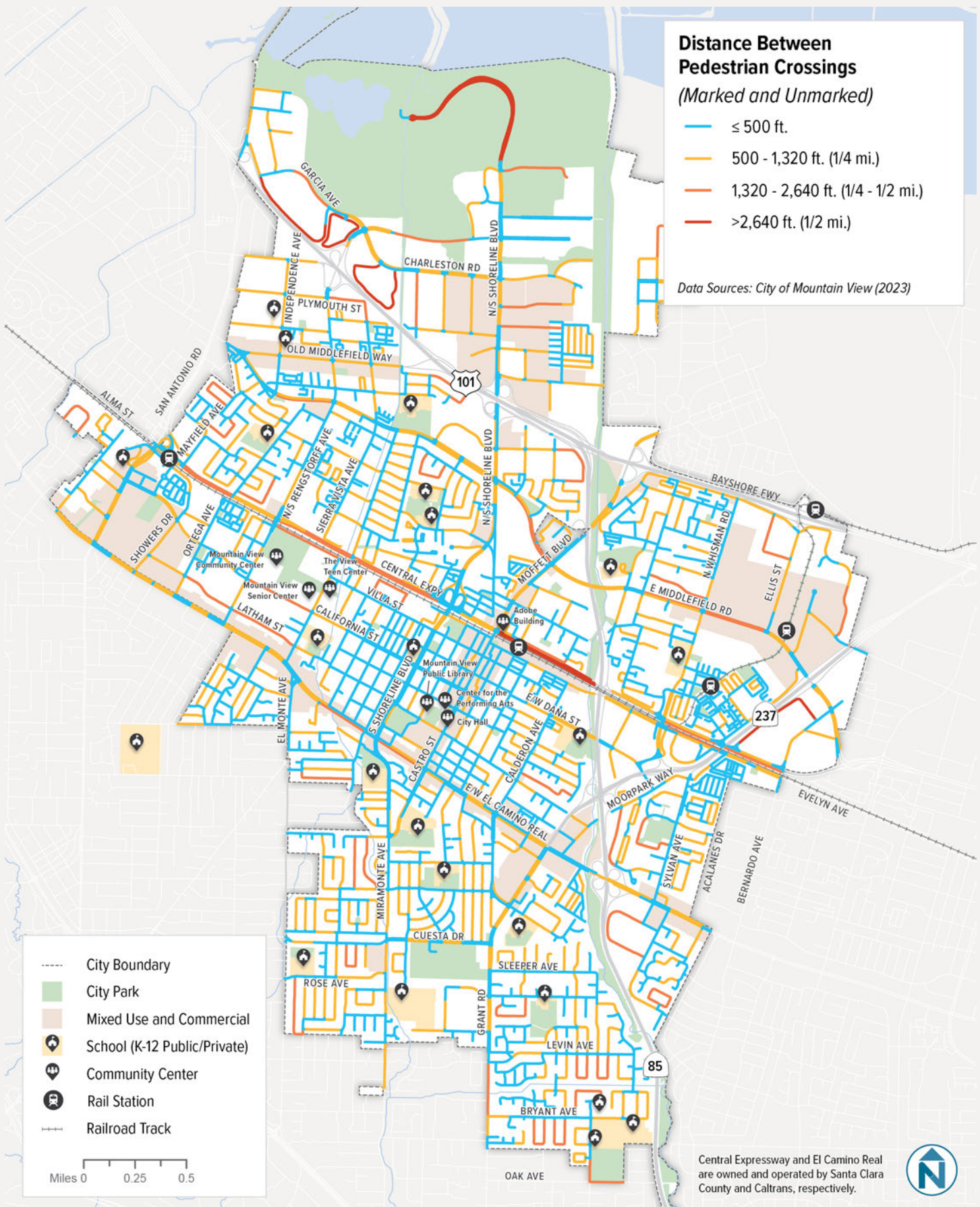
However, crossing roadways with higher speeds and multiple lanes was a recurring comfort and safety concern from Mountain View residents, particularly along larger arterial roads such as El Camino Real and Central Expressway. It is important to note that some of these larger arterial roads are under jurisdiction of Caltrans or Santa Clara County. This is particularly an issue where signalized crossing opportunities are more widely spaced, shown in Figure 16.

FIGURE 15 MARKED CROSSWALKS IN MOUNTAIN VIEW



To improve the pedestrian network, the City continues to enhance crossings and intersections with features that support pedestrian and bicycle safety, such as high visibility crosswalks, raised crosswalks, RRFBs, pedestrian hybrid beacons (PHBs), wave-actuated pedestrian push buttons, and removal of visual barriers near intersections.





BICYCLE NETWORK

The city has a varied network of bicycle facilities (Figure 18), some of which are well connected and some of which are fragmented due to gaps or barriers. The city has 2.0 linear miles of Class IV protected bikeway, 24.3 miles of Class I trail, and 27.6 linear miles of Class II bike lanes.

People vary in their comfort, physical ability, and willingness to accept risk when traveling through the city. In Access MV, the City's multimodal transportation plan, the City identified a future all ages and abilities (AAA) bicycle network comprising existing facilities and planned or funded projects (Figure 19). The network includes bicycle boulevards, trails such as Stevens Creek Trail—which provides a continuous AAA connection between the city's northern and southern areas—protected bikeways, and bicycle lanes on lower-speed, lower-volume streets. The Access MV network map served as the foundation for developing this plan's bicycle network. Mountain View will also consider implementing *slow streets*: low-traffic, shared streets that prioritize walking, bicycling, and community safety while limiting vehicle through traffic. These streets remain open to drivers accessing homes and businesses, but traffic-calming measures discourage through trips.

Parks and trails are among the community's favorite places to walk, bicycle, and roll, serving as both routes and enjoyable, car-free destinations. Survey respondents described using the Stevens Creek Trail for recreational rides, commuting, and reaching everyday places such as grocery stores and the library. However, not all neighborhoods have good connections to the trail network. Bicycle tour and survey participants noted difficult trail access conditions such as safety bollards, crossing challenges, a lack of trailheads and sidewalk gaps where Stevens Creek Trail meets major corridors such as Evelyn Ave, El Camino Real, Moffett Boulevard and West Middlefield Road, requesting or noting a need for improvements to the Permanente Creek Trail and its neighborhood connections.

Bicycle Parking and End-of-Trip Facilities

A complete bicycle network includes other supportive infrastructure and facilities including safe and secure bicycle parking, accurate bicycle detection, bicycle maintenance stations, restrooms, drinking fountains, and clear wayfinding for bicyclists.

FIGURE 17 EXAMPLE OF BICYCLE RACK



FIGURE 18 TYPES OF BICYCLE FACILITIES IN MOUNTAIN VIEW'S ALL AGES AND ABILITIES (AAA) BICYCLE NETWORK



Trails (Class I) are shared-use bicycle and pedestrian paths that are physically separated from motor vehicle travel lanes, typically through horizontal separation and/or grade separation. In Mountain View, most Class I trails are paved, though some may be unpaved or have natural surface treatments.



Bicycle lanes (Class II) are striped bicycle facilities that do not include a physical barrier separating cyclists from motor vehicle lanes.

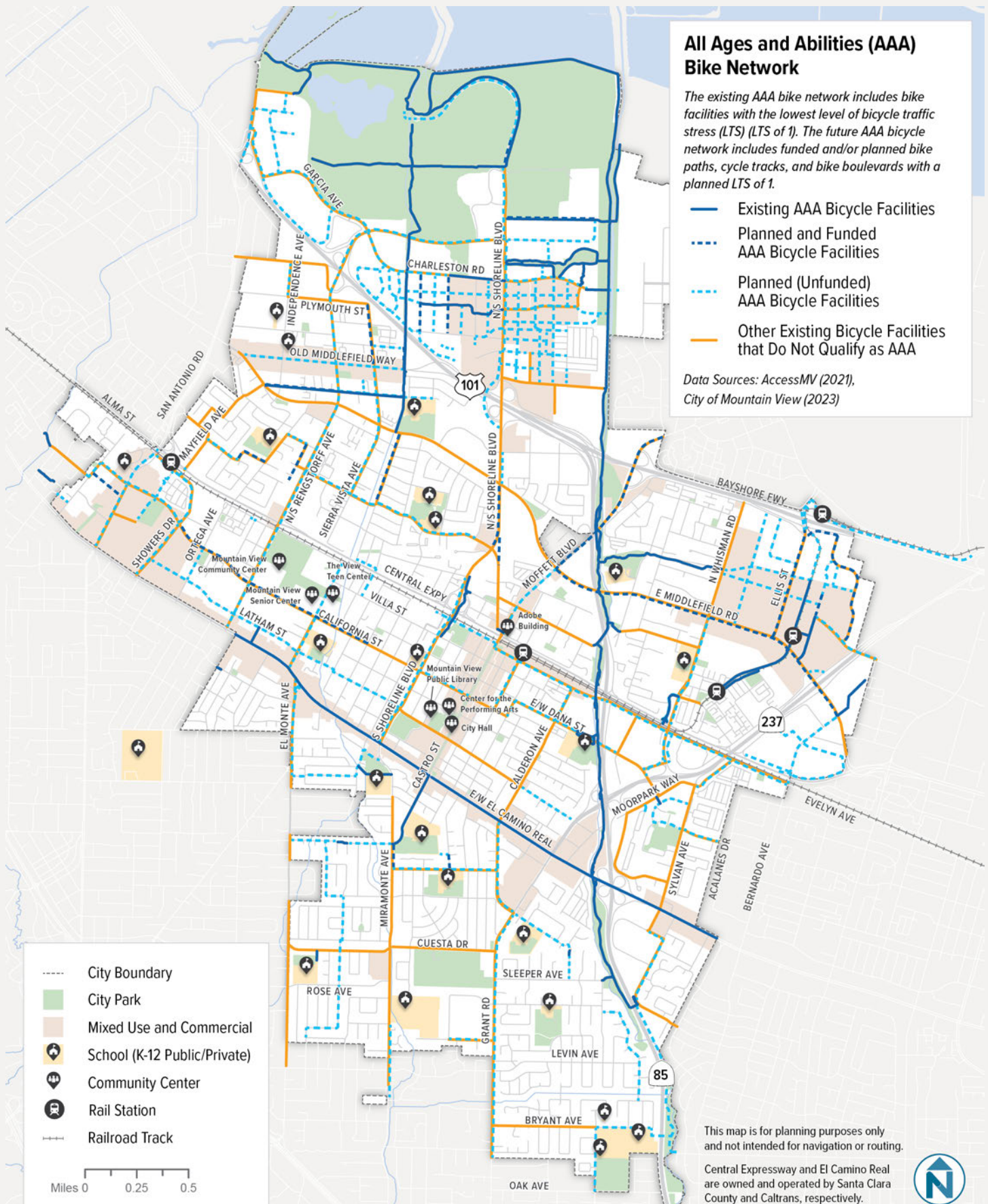


Bicycle boulevards (Class IIIB) and bike routes (Class III) are shared streets with low motor vehicle speeds and volumes, featuring design elements and pavement markings intended to prioritize bicycles. Slow streets could be considered at some locations.



Protected bikeways (Class IV) are bicycle facilities with physical barriers between bicyclists and motorized vehicles. Physical barriers can be provided with flexible plastic posts, concrete, plants and trees, or other treatments.

FIGURE 19
EXISTING AND PLANNED/FUNDED AAA BICYCLE FACILITIES VS. EXISTING BICYCLE NETWORK



Note: This map shows the all ages and abilities network identified in the 2021 AccessMV analysis, which served as the starting point for this plan's bicycle network development. The MVATP's recommended bicycle network, presented later in this chapter (Figure 27), upgrades facility types on some of these corridors.

LTS (Level of Traffic Stress): a measure of how comfortable or stressful a roadway is for bicyclists based on traffic speed, volume, and bike facility conditions.

TRANSIT IN MOUNTAIN VIEW

Transit connections are made by walking, biking and rolling. Mountain View is well served by several high-quality regional and local transit services.

VTA light rail station areas like Whisman Station are well connected by a complete sidewalk network and low-stress bicycle routes. In some areas, such as Pacific Drive near Whisman Station, station area planning has helped create walkable, shaded streets that improve transit access for people who walk, bicycle, and roll.

FIGURE 20 TRANSIT ACCESS CONDITIONS IN MOUNTAIN VIEW

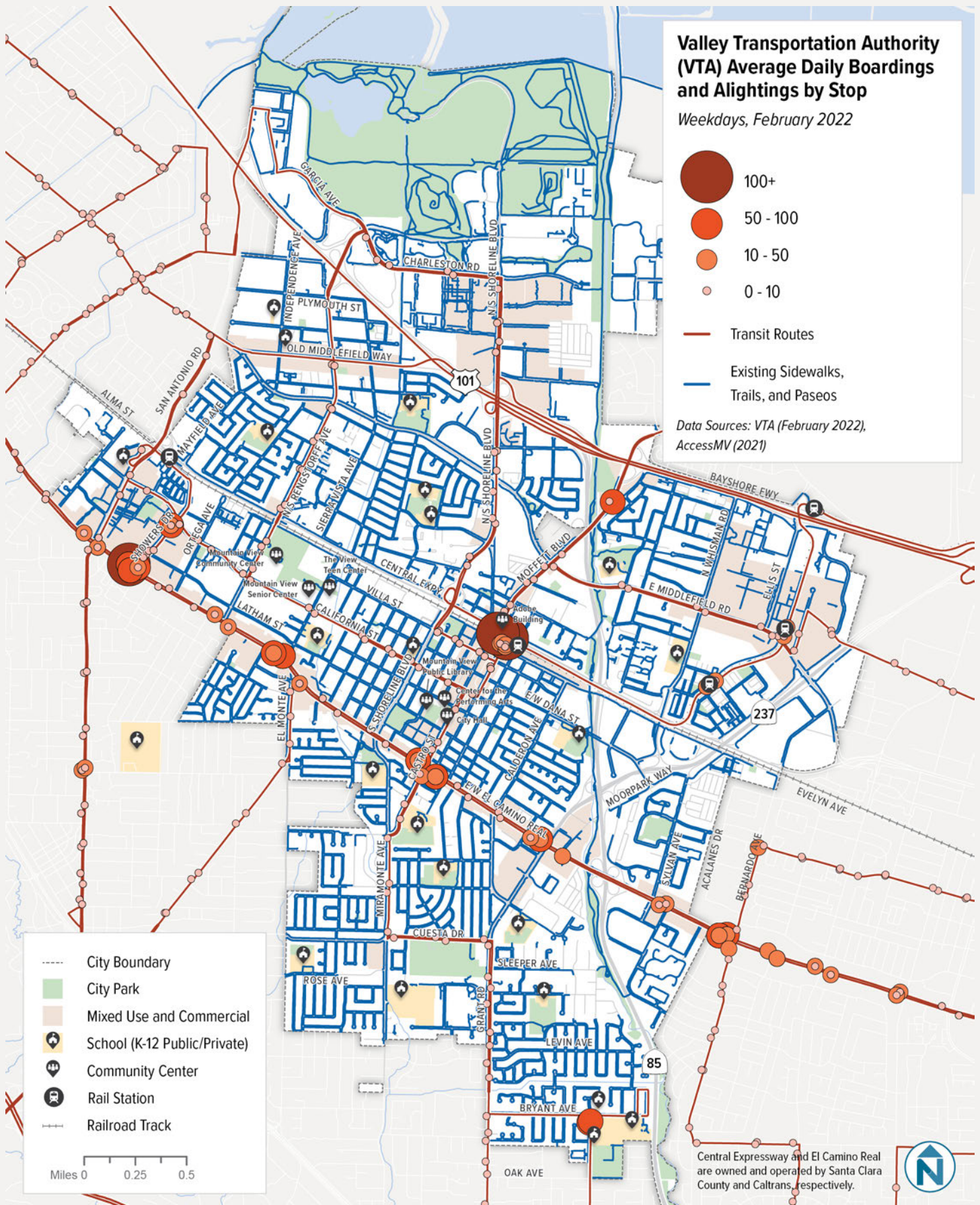


In most of the city, bus services on major roads and arterials are connected to adjacent neighborhoods via low-stress bicycle and pedestrian routes (Figure 20).

Survey respondents noted that the major arterials are some of the more challenging routes and crossing locations, making first and the last mile transit access important for active transportation infrastructure design.

TRANSIT SERVICES IN MOUNTAIN VIEW

- Caltrain commuter rail service
- VTA light rail service
- VTA bus service (including Rapid Bus Route 522 on El Camino Real)
- Mountain View Community Shuttle service
- MVgo commute-hour shuttles



Safety

Between 2015 and 2022, Mountain View reported 563 crashes involving people walking and biking, including 11 fatal and 52 severe injury crashes. According to the 2024 Mountain View Local Road Safety Plan (LRSP), 73% of fatal and severe injury (FSI) collisions occurred along arterials with higher vehicle speeds (35 mph or above), more vehicle lanes, and higher traffic volume.

Pedestrian collisions (typically involving a motor vehicle) were particularly concentrated along arterial roadways, which represent 20% of the city’s street network. FSI bicycle crashes were more distributed throughout the city. However, both pedestrian and bicycle FSI crash locations overlapped with locations that community members reported as challenging in the MVATP survey. (Figure 22 and Figure 23). The top community-identified challenging locations are summarized in Table 4. These ten challenging spots all involve a roadway owned and operated by Caltrans or Santa Clara County, making sustained collaboration with these partner agencies essential to improving safety in Mountain View.*

TABLE 4 TOP 10 CHALLENGING SPOTS FOR WALKING, BIKING, AND ROLLING AS INDICATED BY COMMUNITY INPUT

CHALLENGING SPOTS
Rengstorff Avenue & Central Expressway (and by extension: Rengstorff Avenue & Leland Avenue/Crisanto Avenue)
Castro Street/Moffett Boulevard & Central Expressway (and by extension: Castro Street & Evelyn Avenue)
El Camino Real & Castro Street
Central Expressway & Shoreline Boulevard
Grant Road & El Camino Real
Miramonte Avenue/Shoreline Boulevard & El Camino Real
SR-85 & El Camino Real
SR-101 & Shoreline Boulevard
SR-85 & Central Expressway
El Camino Real & Escuela Avenue

Crash types at intersections included conflicts during turning movements and broadsides, whereas crashes along the road often involved vehicle lane departures. There are several potential roadway improvements such as protected bicycle lanes, curb extensions, and/or pedestrian interval phasing and bicycle signals that may reduce conflict points and should be considered when designing multimodal streets.

**As of mid-2026, Caltrans is leading a Comprehensive Multimodal Corridor Plan for the segment of El Camino Real in Santa Clara County and the County is seeking funds for a study to explore the feasibility of improving bicycle and pedestrian accommodations on Central Expressway. Both efforts will identify bicycle and pedestrian improvements. City staff are providing input into the Caltrans CMCP and will provide input into the County’s study once it begins.*

FIGURE 22
FREQUENCY OF COLLISIONS INVOLVING PEOPLE WALKING AND CHALLENGING LOCATIONS

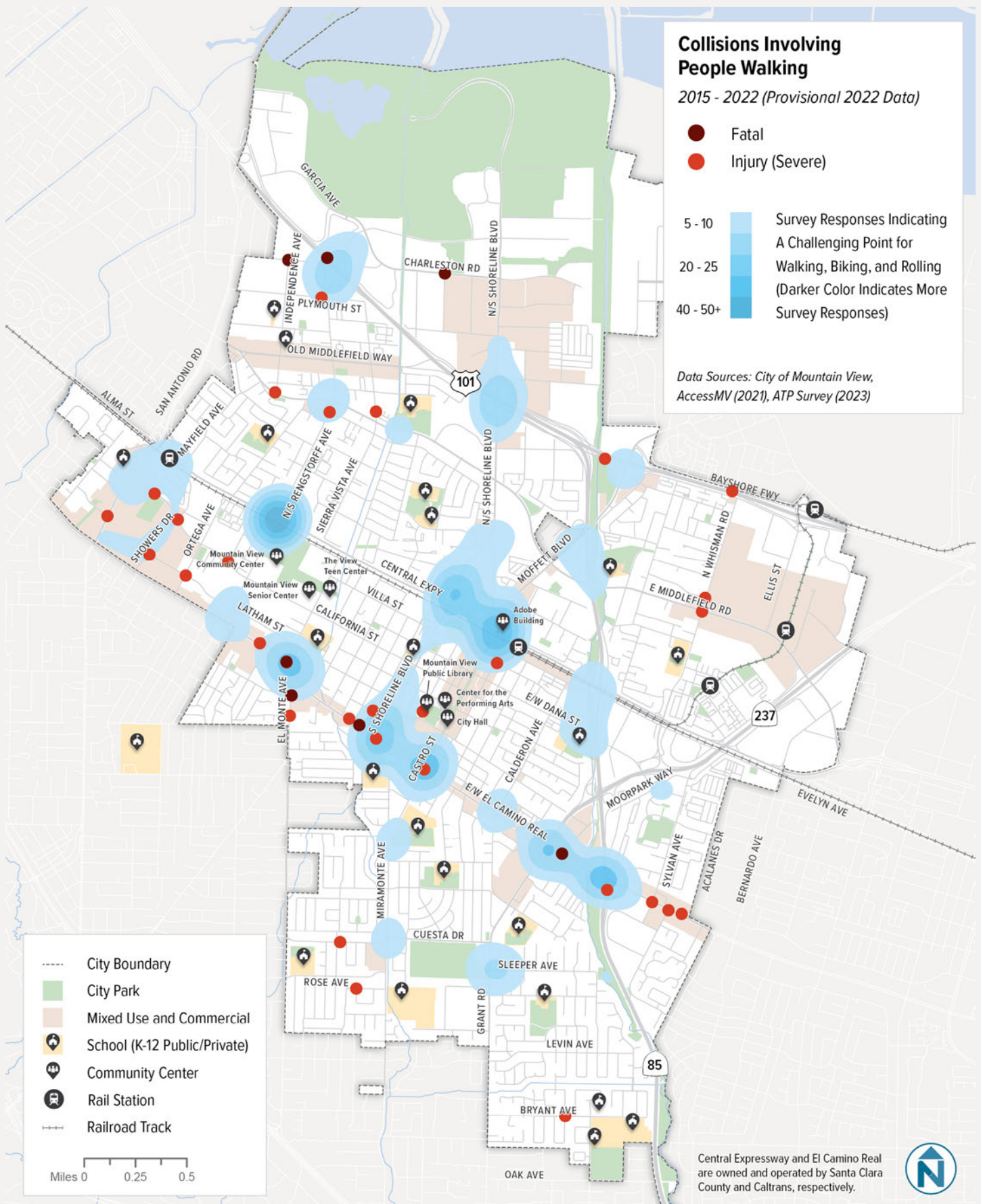
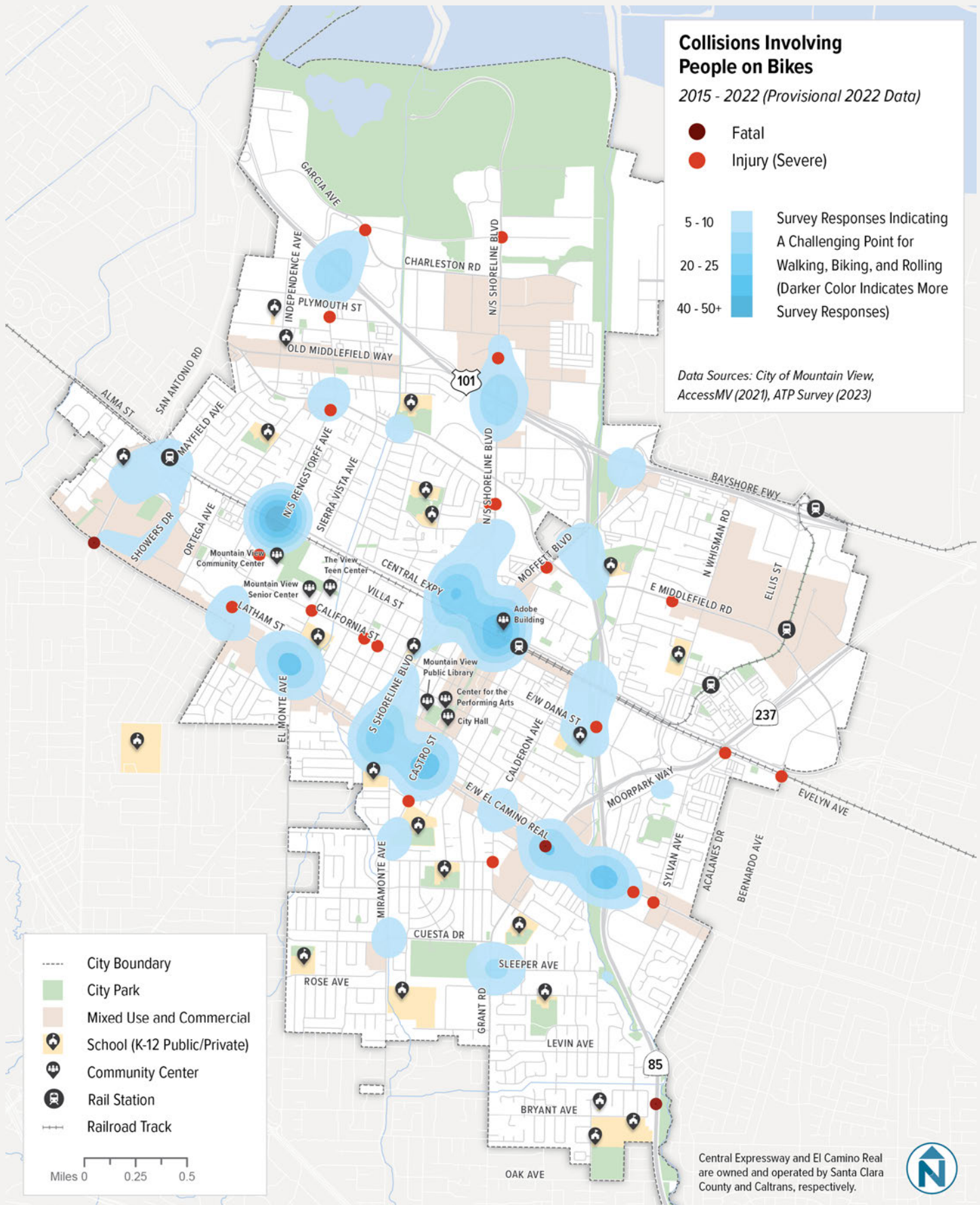


FIGURE 23
FREQUENCY OF COLLISIONS INVOLVING PEOPLE ON BICYCLE AND CHALLENGING LOCATIONS



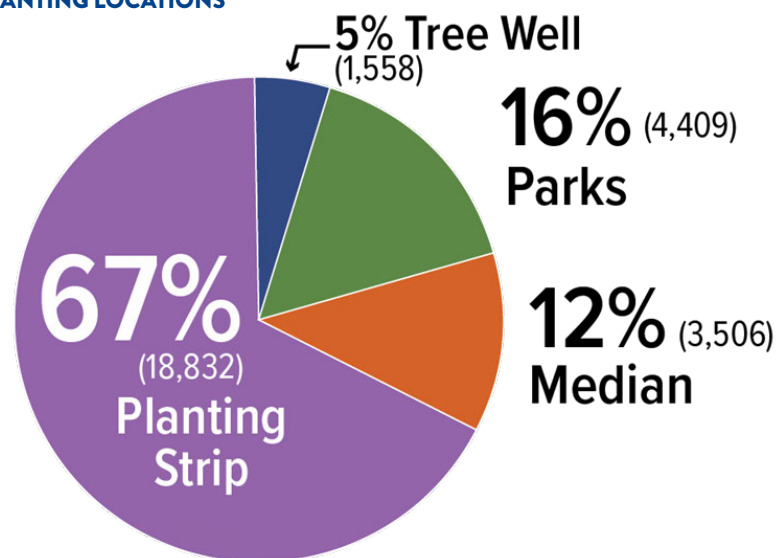
GREEN STREETS

In 2021, the Mountain View City Council established a goal to “protect and enhance local ecosystems and biodiversity through rewilding and other measures” as part of their Sustainability & Climate Resiliency strategic priority. In 2026, the City adopted a Biodiversity and Urban Forest Plan (BUPF) to enhance the health of local ecosystems and prevent species loss through a multi-pronged approach. One element of this approach is planning for active transportation networks that double as wildlife corridors to preserve biodiversity assets, create new spaces for local native plants, and support local ecosystems.

Green Streets are a holistic approach that combines active transportation, biodiversity promotion, and green infrastructure development. Including Green Streets as a component of the MVATP presents a unique opportunity to support Mountain View’s sustainability and biodiversity goals by providing space for natural systems to thrive within the public right-of-way, while influencing how people use the street, often slowing motor vehicle traffic and increasing the comfort of pedestrians and cyclists of all ages and abilities by creating space and incorporating natural elements into the street. Metrics in the Biodiversity and Urban Forest Plan will evaluate green street projects for their contribution to canopy coverage, native species integration, habitat corridor function, and stormwater performance.

For the purpose of identifying possible improvements and developing project concepts (discussed in Chapter 3), the MVATP focused on two aspects of sustainability and biodiversity/green streets: plantable space and impervious surface cover.

FIGURE 24 PUBLIC TREE PLANTING LOCATIONS



Source: City of Mountain View - Tree Technical Manual

PLANTABLE SPACE

Trees are a valuable community resource and an essential component of civic infrastructure. The City of Mountain View has been committed to preserving and enhancing its urban forest since 1960 when the City Council established tree care services. Street trees provide important shade, cooling, stormwater, water pollution reduction, and air purification services.

Approximately 2/3 of public trees are found in planting strips, which represents the biggest opportunity for additional community trees (Figure 24). Planting strips with trees adjacent to the roadway also provide an important physical buffer between the pedestrian and vehicular space, increasing comfort, safety and shade. Incorporating street trees into roadway capital projects can move the city toward realizing the 22.7 percent tree canopy coverage goal established in the 2015 Community Tree Master Plan and restated in the BUFP. Bicycle and pedestrian projects identified in the MVATP provide an opportunity to plant trees and shrubs in planting strips, medians, and bikeway buffers, directly contributing to that goal.

New plantings also present an opportunity to increase the proportion of local native species. Native trees such as Coast Live Oak, Valley Oak, and California Buckeye provide biodiversity benefits that common non-native species do not, supporting the pollinators and ecosystems of this region. The city's BUFP establishes the city's approach to native planting and canopy goals.

IMPERVIOUS SURFACES

Impervious surfaces include concrete and asphalt surfaces, roofs, and other hard materials that do not allow water to soak into the ground. On the other hand, porous surfaces, like gardens and other unpaved areas, allow water to soak into the ground. Impervious surfaces affect the environment and natural systems in various ways, causing more stormwater runoff, flood risk and water pollution, and higher surface temperatures. Greening strategies, such as planting strips, tree wells, landscaped medians, and bicycle buffers, can increase pervious surfaces. These green street elements make a positive difference in areas filled with impervious surfaces by soaking up rainwater and cooling the surroundings, improving the overall environment in Mountain View neighborhoods, and are consistent with the BUFP.

Key Takeaways

COMMUNITY SUPPORT FOR ACTIVE TRANSPORTATION

Mountain View is an active community. Through the survey, walk and bicycle tours, and data analysis, Mountain View residents noted the desire to walk, bicycle, and roll safely throughout the community. They desire access to key destinations such as shopping, schools, parks and transit. They also want end-of-trip support, such as secure bicycle parking at locations throughout the city to make it feasible and desirable to travel by active modes.

OPPORTUNITIES FOR A HOLISTIC ACTIVE TRANSPORTATION NETWORK

As demonstrated in the findings presented in this chapter, Mountain View has a strong foundation for its active transportation network. However, opportunities for improvement exist, whether filling gaps in the pedestrian and bicycle network or improving the quality of the existing infrastructure to increase connectivity, safety, comfort and sustainability. Holistic active transportation network maps were developed to highlight these future opportunities to expand the quantity and quality of the active transportation network in Mountain View (Figure 25, Figure 26, and Figure 27).

The holistic network maps serve several purposes. They represent the complete pedestrian and bicycle network the city is working toward over the life of this plan and beyond, a long-term vision rather than a committed project list. By mapping the full network, they ensure that individual improvements connect to one another and build toward a citywide system rather than isolated segments. The improvements shown on these maps formed the full set of over 100 potential projects that were evaluated and scored through the process described in Chapter 3, with the highest scoring improvements becoming the priority projects. The maps also guide decisions beyond the priority projects, informing the review of private development along the network, the design of street maintenance and repaving projects, and the pursuit of grant funding, so that each of these opportunities contributes to completing the network over time.

The holistic maps in this chapter present the full long-term network vision. Improvements shown on the holistic maps but not identified as priority projects remain part of the plan and may advance as opportunities arise.

Note: The Policy on Unimproved Streets adopted by City Council in 1993 affirms the direction to not construct sidewalks in residential areas unless homeowners initiate an assessment district to fund these sidewalk. The policy references resident desires to maintain the rural character of these streets by not improving streets to current standards. Many missing sidewalks shown on the holistic pedestrian network maps are in these unimproved areas and are not proposed for construction under current policy.

